

CONTESTANT NUMBER _____



UNIVERSITY INTERSCHOLASTIC LEAGUE

COPY EDITING CONTEST

INVITATIONAL B 2026

This test is produced, and should be graded,
using the 2024-2026 Associated Press Stylebook, 57th edition,
in print or updated on or before June 1, 2024, online.

Students may use the AP Stylebook, dictionary and/or thesaurus
during the exam.

FOR JUDGE'S USE

Points from
PART 1

Points from
PART 2

TOTAL
POINTS

POINTS/15

POINTS/20

POINTS/35

PLACE

PART 3
is graded
ONLY
to break ties.

DO NOT TURN THIS PAGE UNTIL YOU ARE INSTRUCTED TO DO SO!

RECOMMENDED EDITING MARKS

Students should use clearly understood editing symbols.

Students will NOT be penalized for using other symbols.

It is up to the judges to determine if marks are “clearly understood.”

¶ or L

¶ Leaguetown High School will undergo renovations this summer. ¶ “This is long overdue,” Principal Mike Macall said.
“I’m so glad to see it’s finally happening.”

indent for paragraph

paragraph

no paragraph

⤿

His complaints are just grapes sour.

transpose

○

They’ve been married eleven years.

use figures

She lives in Austin, TX.

spell out

○

Superintendent Lyle Keen addressed the school board

abbreviate

Jr. Joe Smith can’t wait until he’s a senior.

don’t abbreviate

≡

I love my english class.

uppercase

/

High School can be fun and interesting.

lowercase

⌒

Happy Thanks giving!

remove space

└┐

When his family moves, he will have to change high schools.

insert space

STET

He uses ^{STET} two pencils for tests.

ignore correction

↗

I can’t wait for that the movie to come out.

delete

^

insert comma

’

insert apostrophe

"

insert quotation marks

⦿ ⊗

insert period

≡

insert hyphen

—

insert dash

COPY EDITING CONTEST

Invitational B

DIRECTIONS: This test is divided into three sections. All three sections are mandatory. Write all your responses as indicated. You have 15 minutes.

PART 1: Circle the correct response. (1 pt. each)

1. She will soon need a **Seeing Eye** / **seeing eye** dog.
2. Did Lisa's news **peek** / **peak** / **pique** your interest?
3. I'll mail the card as soon as I find the **zip** / **Zip** / **ZIP** code.
4. He was **reticent** / **reluctant** to answer her questions.
5. The student was very **conscientous**/ **conscientious** when it came to her homework.
6. I love all math subjects, **i.e.**, / **e.g.**, algebra, geometry, calculus.
7. My dad just bought a **jet ski** / **Jet Ski**.
8. How far did you **pedal** / **peddle** your bike today?
9. The officer conducted **surveillance**/ **surveillance** on the suspect.
10. She hated being **nearsighted** / **near-sighted** and planned to have laser surgery.
11. The ship sailed through the **Strait** / **Straits** of Gibraltar.
12. He needed another **two-by-four** / **2 x 4** to complete the project.
13. She finds ice cream **irresistable**/ **irresistible**.
14. She is the **sovereign**/ **soveriegn** of the nation.
15. The funds raised **totaled** / **totalled** \$3,852.

TOTAL _____/15

UIL COPY EDITING INVITATIONAL B 2026

PART 2: Edit the following sentences to eliminate/correct **FOUR** (and only four) errors in wordiness, AP style, grammar, spelling or punctuation in each of the five statements below. Use clearly understood editing symbols. Spelling errors should be corrected, not simply marked for correction. Judges will only evaluate the first four corrections the contestant makes. Judges will ignore any additional corrections beyond the first four. Contestants will receive points for correct edits but will not receive points if they miss a correction, include unnecessary corrections or use unclear editing symbols. Compound errors such as changing “First Lady” to “first lady” will be considered as one error. (4 pts. each)

POINTS

0 1 2 3 4 1. We plan to visit the 8 mountain states this summer including Colorado and

Utah my favorites. They're beautiful.

0 1 2 3 4 2. We have less than twenty people signed up for the fund-raiser. Well need

several more volunteers so we can make enough money for our trip.

0 1 2 3 4 3. The drama in this highschool is unbelievable, people need to learn to be

indiscrete so that every one can get along better.

0 1 2 3 4 4. When an itchy bump appeared on her arm after her hike she assumed it

was a mosquito bite. However she found out she has lyme disease.

0 1 2 3 4 5. The dish included broccolli and zuchini, 2 vegetables I hate. I ate some to be

polite but I hated it.

TOTAL

_____/20

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PART 3: In the space provided, edit the following news brief to make the wording clear, to eliminate wordiness as well as any errors in AP style, grammar, spelling or punctuation. You do NOT have to rewrite the news brief. Make notes of anything you believe needs clarification, additional research or additional reporting. PART 3 WILL BE USED ONLY TO BREAK TIES BUT IS REQUIRED. In the event of a tie, if you do not make any effort on Part 3, your entire entry will be DISQUALIFIED.

The district is expected to save tons of money, \$2 million, from being partially solar-powered. This change isn't occurring for approximately 2 years and will happen in 2026.

The school is expecting to save \$2 million dollars, and also conserve about 416,948 gallons of gas over 25 years of having the solar panels.

"I think it's terrific for schools to be environmentally conscious." Emma Bolton (Junior) states on the topic. The initiative for the change has already taken place, as the district has approved it. Leaguetown Energy will install the panels and is putting them at no cost.

The money saved will could help with the school budget.

Kerri Taylor (Senior) "I don't really mind, if it saves money and isn't going to change anything in a negative way then go for it."

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ANSWER KEY

PART I

1. Seeing Eye

2. pique

3. ZIP

4. reticent

5. conscientious

6. e.g.,

7. Jet Ski

8. pedal

9. surveillance

10. nearsighted

11. Strait

12. two-by-four

13. irresistible

14. sovereign

15. totaled

PART 2

1. We plan to visit the ⑧ mountain states this summer including Colorado

and Utah my favorites. They're beautiful.

2. We have ^{fewer} less than ② people signed up for the fund-raiser. We'll need

several more volunteers so we can make enough money for our trip.

3. The drama in this high school is unbelievable. people need to learn to be

in discreet so that every one can get along better.

4. When an itchy bump appeared on her arm after her hike she assumed

it was a mosquito bite. However she found out she has Lyme disease.

5. The dish included broccoli and zucchini, ② vegetables I hate. I ate some

to be polite but I hated it.

UIL COPY EDITING INVITATIONAL B 2026

PART 3: In the space provided, edit the following news brief to make the wording clear and to eliminate wordiness as well as any errors in AP style, grammar, spelling or punctuation. You do NOT have to rewrite the news brief. Make notes of anything you believe needs clarification, additional research or additional reporting. PART 3 WILL BE USED ONLY TO BREAK TIES BUT IS REQUIRED. In the event of a tie, if you do not make any effort on Part 3, your entire entry will be DISQUALIFIED.

NOTES TO JUDGES

Part 3

This section is ranked to break a tie in the combined scores of Parts 1 and 2. Assign no points.

Judges should compare the papers of students who tied, ranking them accordingly.

When judging Part 3, holistically read the changes the student indicated starting with the highest level of editing.

- Highest level: Are there any legal or ethical issues with the story?

- Middle level: Does the story use the right sources? Does it flow?

- Lowest level: Grammar, spelling, punctuation, style

• •

¶1 — This is much too wordy.

¶2 — Don't need to say save \$2 million twice. End of first sentence is awkward. Any change that sounds more clear will work.

¶3 — Attribution should be title, name then said. Sentences need to be more concise.

¶5 — Avoid putting attribution at beginning of sentence.

The district is expected to save ~~tons of money, \$2 million, from being partially~~ ^{when it becomes} solar-powered. ~~This change isn't occurring for approximately 2 years and will~~ ^g happen ^g in 2026.

The school is ~~expecting to save \$2 million dollars, and also conserve about~~ ^{should} 416,948 gallons of gas ~~over 25 years of having the solar panels.~~ ^{after} ^{panel use}

"I think it's terrific for schools to be environmentally conscious," ^{junior} Emma Bolton

^{after} ~~(Junior)~~ [¶] states on the topic. The initiative ~~for the change has already taken place,~~ ^g

~~as the district has approved it. Leaguetown Energy will install the panels and is~~ ^{the change} putting them ^g at no cost.

The money saved will could help with the school budget.

~~Kerri Taylor (Senior)~~ ^g "I don't really mind, ^{senior Kerri Taylor said.} if it saves money and isn't going to

change anything in a negative way ^g then go for it."